

THE DAILY BRIEF

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AI & TECH

Latest in artificial intelligence, models, and technology

AMD's Helios System Targets Nvidia's AI Dominance With a New Rack-Scale Architecture. AMD unveiled Helios, its latest AI rack-scale system, in a direct challenge to Nvidia's commanding position in the AI hardware market. The system is designed to scale across multiple racks and is aimed at data centers running large AI workloads. While AMD has gained ground in discrete GPUs, Nvidia still controls roughly 80% of the data center AI accelerator market. Helios represents AMD's most aggressive push yet to close that gap. (TechCrunch)

Mobileye CEO Amnon Shashua to Step Aside as the Company Pivots Toward Robotaxis and Robotics. Mobileye announced that CEO Amnon Shashua will step down from his executive role, marking the end of an era for the Intel-owned autonomous driving company. Shashua co-founded Mobileye in 1999 and built it into the dominant supplier of Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) chips before selling it to Intel for \$15.3 billion in 2017. Mobileye went public again in 2022. The company is now pushing beyond ADAS into full robotaxi services and robotics applications. (TechCrunch)

The AI Kill Switch Act: Congress Moves to Give the Trump Administration Power to Shut Down Rogue AI. A bipartisan bill introduced in the Senate, dubbed the AI Kill Switch Act, would grant the Trump administration authority to order the shutdown of AI systems deemed national security risks. The legislation comes as AI systems become increasingly integrated into critical infrastructure. Civil liberties groups have raised concerns about the breadth of the proposed executive powers. Supporters argue the Act is a necessary backstop as AI capabilities accelerate faster than regulatory frameworks can keep pace. (Ars Technica)

Google Fined \$1 Billion by the European Union as Trade Tensions With the US Escalate. The European Union hit Google with a record \$1 billion fine, marking one of the largest regulatory penalties ever imposed on a US tech company. The timing is politically charged: the fine arrives as the EU and US are locked in broader trade disputes under the Trump administration's tariff regime. Google said it would appeal. This is the latest in a long-running series of EU antitrust actions against Google, which have resulted in more than \$9 billion in total fines over the past decade. (Ars Technica)

FINANCIAL & MARKETS

Stock markets, crypto, DeFi, and economic indicators

BitMEX Co-Founders, Including Arthur Hayes, Face Fraud Claims as Exchange Winds Down. Arthur Hayes, the controversial former BitMEX CEO, and the exchange's co-founders are facing fresh fraud allegations tied to an alleged "insider trading desk" as the exchange winds down operations. BitMEX was once the world's largest crypto derivatives exchange but has seen volume collapse amid increased competition from Binance, Bybit, and Coinbase. The Commodity Futures Trading Commission (CFTC) has been investigating the exchange for years. Hayes, known for his colorful

persona and frequent media appearances, has denied the allegations. (The Block)

Poolin, Once a Major Bitcoin Mining Pool, Files for Chapter 11 Bankruptcy. Poolin, once one of the world's largest Bitcoin mining pools, filed for Chapter 11 bankruptcy protection with a \$52 million floor bid for its Texas mining operations. At its peak, Poolin accounted for a significant share of Bitcoin's hashrate. The filing reflects the continued pressure on Bitcoin miners following the 2024-2025 hashrate wars and the block reward halving. Poolin's fall is the latest in a string of high-profile crypto mining bankruptcies. (The Block)

Coinbase Calls AI Payments Its 'Most High-Conviction Bet' as Businesses Begin Accepting Agent-to-Agent Payments. Coinbase CEO Brian Armstrong said AI-driven payments — specifically AI agents paying other AI agents for services — represents the exchange's highest-conviction growth opportunity. Early experiments show AI agents are already transacting on-chain: paying for compute, API calls, and digital services autonomously. Coinbase is building infrastructure to make crypto the default settlement layer for machine-to-machine commerce. This is a significant pivot: Coinbase is historically a retail-focused exchange, but the AI agent economy could create an entirely new institutional-grade B2B revenue stream. (The Block)

Robinhood CEO's X Account Hacked; Attacker Promotes Vladhoo Memecoin. Robinhood CEO Vlad Tenev's X account was compromised, with the attacker using it to promote a memecoin called Vladhoo. The exchange quickly flagged the token as a scam. This is at least the third high-profile X account hack promoting crypto memecoins in the past year, highlighting the ongoing vulnerability of social media accounts to sophisticated phishing and SIM-swap attacks — and the continued retail appetite for memecoins regardless of legitimate backing. (The Block)

BRIEFLY

◀ **Meta Exits Clean Energy Pact:** Meta withdrew from a major clean energy purchasing agreement as its natural gas buildout accelerates to power AI data centers. The company's renewable energy commitments are under scrutiny as power demand from AI infrastructure surges. (TechCrunch)

◀ **Google: Log In With a Selfie:** Google rolled out biometric password recovery, allowing users to regain access to their accounts using a selfie rather than answering security questions or receiving SMS codes. The feature is available now and is part of Google's broader push to kill the password. (Ars Technica)

◀ **Sony's Disc Decision Was Inevitable:** Data shows the PlayStation game disc has been dying for years — retail disc sales as a share of total PlayStation game revenue had been declining steadily since 2018. Sony's decision to go fully digital was the culmination of a decade-long trend, not a sudden shift. (Ars Technica)

THE TAKEAWAY

Three themes are converging this Friday: hardware is getting competitive again, regulators are catching up to AI, and crypto is finding new use cases in the AI economy. AMD's Helios challenges Nvidia's moat at the same moment that Coinbase is betting the next wave of crypto volume comes from AI agents paying each other — not retail traders buying memecoins. Meanwhile, the BitMEX and Poolin stories are reminders that crypto's consolidation is not yet complete, and the regulatory overhang from the Hayes case will linger. The AI Kill Switch Act is the most consequential policy

development of the week — if it passes, every AI company building for the US market will need a federal compliance strategy.

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